

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Don't ask me to speak in front of all those people!



Learning Outcome

Describe situations in spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How do you feel when you are asked to speak in public?
- Have you ever thought about acting in a play? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about work and entertainment.
- I can talk about emotions and reactions in different situations.
- I can make and respond to suggestions.





Let's Explore!

Actors have to memorize lines!



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Have you ever felt nervous speaking in front of your class or some other group of people? Most people get nervous if they speak in public. When they don't feel any stress, it's nice, but unusual.

According to some advice given to actors, if you're nervous, you want to do a good job. Most actors have felt this to varying degrees before they walked onto the stage and faced their audience. Some have even asked someone backstage to give them a push when they felt more stage fright than usual. If you ask stage actors about this, most admit it freely. It happens to everyone at least once.

Getting over that nervous feeling is just one challenge for theater actors. They have to memorize lines, remember where to stand, and of course, be convincing. They also do it live. It has to be right the first time, every time!

When I asked an actor friend what I should do when I was nervous, he said, "You should try imagining the crowd is naked! I did that once. Do you think you might find a place to stretch to relax? I've done that for years. You could always chew gum to ease the tension in your jaw as well. When your stomach has butterflies, a banana helps. I've eaten a banana on opening night!"

I thought, "Yes, I should do that!", "I agree, stretching sounds good!" "Chewing gum, is a possibility!", and "No, bananas aren't for me!" Problem solved. Just don't ever ask me to step out onto a Broadway stage!





Let's Practice!

Actors express their emotions before acting.

Instructions: Circle the mistakes in the sentences. Rewrite the corrected sentences below. Practice reading the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Has you ever feel nervous speaking in front of your class or some other group of people?

2. Most actors has felt this to varying degrees before they walking onto the stage and faced their audience.

3. Some have even ask someone backstage to give them a push when they felt more stage fright than usual.

4. I've always chew gum to ease the tension.

5. i've eaten a banana on opening night!



Let's Practice!

Sam is giving some advice!

Instructions: Draw a line to match the sentences in Column A with Column B. Use the completed sentences to model a conversation with your partner. Switch roles.

COLUMN A

1. When your stomach
2. You could try to
3. You should try
4. Do you think you might find
5. You could always chew gum

COLUMN B

- a. has butterflies, a banana helps.
- b. focus when you feel nervous.
- c. imagining the crowd is naked!
- d. a place to stretch to relax?
- e. to ease the tension in your jaw.





Extension Activity

Find out how to keep calm when speaking.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Read the text again.
- Do some research to find some other ways you can help yourself not feel nervous when speaking in front of people.
- Try to come up with 4 more ways.
- Then, write a dialogue between two people. One asks for advice on how to help stay calm when speaking. The other person suggests ways to help stay calm when speaking. The first person responds to the suggestions.
- Practice both parts.
- Read your dialogue with a partner.
- Change parts and read it again.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I read the text again.

☐ ☐

I find ways to not be nervous when speaking in front of people.

☐ ☐

I write a dialogue between two people about ways to not be nervous when speaking in front of people.

☐ ☐

I use modal verbs to make suggestions.

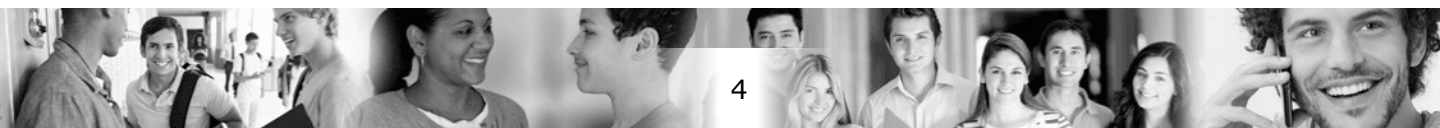
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I respond to suggestions.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- in public** (expression): in a place where you can be seen by many people
e.g. Most people get nervous if they speak in public.
- to varying degrees** (expression): not all at the same levels or abilities
e.g. Most actors have felt this to varying degrees before they walked onto the stage and faced their audience.
- push** (noun): to use force to move someone or something forward or away from you
e.g. Some have even asked someone backstage to give them a push when they felt more stage fright than usual.
- stage fright** (noun): a nervous feeling felt by someone who is going to appear in front of an audience
e.g. Some actors felt more stage fright than usual.
- to memorize** (verb): to learn something so well that you are able to remember it perfectly
e.g. They have to memorize lines.
- live** (adjective): at the actual time that something (such as a performance or event) happens
e.g. They are also doing the show live.
- to have butterflies** (expression): a nervous feeling in your stomach
e.g. When your stomach has butterflies, a banana helps.





Learning Points

The Present Perfect Tense vs. The Simple Past Tense

You use the **Present Perfect tense** to talk about a past action or an action that began in the past that is connected to the present in some way.

You use the **Simple Past tense** to talk about many kinds of past events: short, quickly finished actions, longer situations and repeated events.

You can use the **Present Perfect tense** to talk about experience. When you use the **Present Perfect tense**, you think about the past and present together. There is some connection between what happened in the past and now.

For example:

I have learned English. = I learned English in the past and now I can speak English.

He has bought a painting. = He bought the painting in the past and now he has a painting.

It is common to use *for* and *since* when referring to time periods in the **Present Perfect**:

- You use **FOR** to talk about how long an action has been happening (a week, 2 days, five hours, six years etc.)
- You use **SINCE** to talk about when the action started (2010, Monday, she was a child)

*I've tried them all. It's been a little better **since**.*

Usually, when you use the **Simple Past tense**, the time of the finished action is clear from the context or explicitly mentioned in the sentence.

For example:

Yesterday, I went to the store.

Before they walked onto the stage and faced their audience ...

It is clear when the action occurred. In this sentence we would not use the **Present Perfect**. (~~Yesterday, I have been to the store~~).

Examples:

- *Have you ever felt nervous speaking in front of your class or some other group of people?*
- *Most actors have felt this to varying degrees before they walked onto the stage and faced their audience.*
- *Some have even asked someone backstage to give them a push when they felt more stage fright than usual.*
- *I did that once.*
- *I've eaten many a banana before opening night! I've tried them all. It's been a little better since.*





Learning Points

Making and Responding to Suggestions

You can use **modals** or the **zero conditional** to make suggestions.

Common phrases with **modals** you use to make suggestions are:

Do you think you might ...?

You could ...

You should ...

You can also use the **zero conditional** to make suggestions in a more indirect way.

For example:

When your stomach has butterflies, a banana helps.

The structure of the **zero conditional** is:

If + **Simple Present**, **Simple Present**

Examples:

- *You should try imagining the crowd is naked!*
- *Do you think you might find a place to stretch?*
- *You could always chew gum to ease the tension in your jaw as well.*
- *When your stomach has butterflies, a banana helps.*

